CHECKPOINT 01 / SOURCE REVIEW

Heralds of the Cemí Anime film development

A staged adaptation of the novel by Luis M. Minier. This packet proposes the first sequence. No animation, voice, music or image-generation jobs have been submitted.

What was inspected

The complete English auto-caption transcript of K.D.Wilson’s eight-minute tutorial, I Made a 90's Anime with AI (Step by Step Guide). The attached novel has 229 PDF pages and 24 chapters in four parts. Book inspection covered its structure, chapter openings and endings, selected lore and causality passages, and the full final two chapters. This is an adaptation review, not a completed line-by-line editorial audit.

The tutorial workflow, applied here

Tutorial time	Production step	Our review point
1:20-1:43	Write clear action lines.	Approve each sequence’s script and additions.
1:45-2:53	Make character/prop references and choose a style.	Approve designs in your existing Cemí style.
2:55-3:39	Compose each cut, then apply consistent references.	Inspect the storyboard and shot continuity.
3:42-4:20	Animate reference frames and edit the clips.	Review one short motion test before a scene.
4:22-5:19	Build consistent voices, ambience and effects separately.	Approve voice samples and a scene sound mix.
5:21-5:51	Match color across shots.	Review the assembled sequence before continuing.

The tutorial also flags object orientation and 2D camera angles as recurring problems (5:56-6:57). For this film, verify canoe travel direction, handedness, prop ownership, faces and ear continuity on every cut. Tool names in auto-captions can be mistranscribed; no current model or pricing claim is inferred from them.

Source: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QCFkgy_4ofU | Transcript exported and read on 11 October 2026.

What the film must carry

Book section	Source pages	Dramatic purpose
Static / Chapters 1-7	11-71	River escape; JC's 3:07 discovery; Aperture's signal; community music; recognition of his own needs and abilities.
Inheritance / Chapters 8-11	75-109	Mikey's absence and exploitation; Mamá funds the trip; Abuela's ledger; the island's living traditions; La Madre and Yúcahu.
Signal / Chapters 12-18	113-175	Learn to hold a room; trust Manny; connect the company's history; JC injures Danny; institutional pressure; repair and shared planning.
The Armory / Chapters 19-24	179-229	Founders' Night; collective resistance; the 10:05 restart; the stones and distant keepers; Mikey reaches JC; consequences and Remembering Night.

Preserve these payoffs

• Aperture provokes conflict, harvests ánimo, and measures the resulting quiet. Its practices connect mills, classrooms, corporate programs and the present app (pp. 92-98, 131-139). Keep its control and harvesting motive visible.

• JC's growth depends on accepting other people's agency. Keep his harm to Danny, his accountability, Yanaisa's authority over Yúcahu, and the community's role in the outcome (Ch. 15, 18, 23-24).

• Mikey is male. The childhood knocks and JC's unanswered message are necessary setup for Mikey opening JC's clenched hand at the climax (pp. 75, 165, 216, 223-224).

• La Madre and Yúcahu remain distinct objects with distinct keepers. The baby's small stone is a delayed reveal in the return to 1523 (pp. 107-108, 208-209).

• JC loses hearing in his right ear during the climax. Preserve the burned hand, Manny's damaged drum and injured ribs, and Danny's continuing injury; the aftermath cannot simply reset them (pp. 212-224).

• The ending includes recovered music, renewed relationships, the restored stone, the 2057 glimpse, and a child being allowed to play. The defeat of the Bronx operation does not erase every surviving part of the organization (pp. 221-229).

Adaptation choices still open: total runtime, any omitted or combined scenes, how much of JC's first-person voice becomes voiceover, and the balance between dialogue and visual storytelling. No cuts or merged characters are approved by this packet.

The river / approximately 90 seconds

Source: Chapter 1, pp. 11-12; later reveal checked against pp. 106 and 209. The durations, framing and edit are proposed film choices. Events and the three spoken lines below come from the supplied PDF. No new story event or dialogue is proposed.

Time	Picture and action	Sound / dialogue
0-12 s	Low beside three moving canoes. Establish mangrove roots, constrained water, eleven survivors. Dairon leads; Yara carries the wrapped cemí.	Paddles, hull friction, Beheto’s difficult breathing. Sparse sound; no explanatory narration proposed.
12-22 s	Close on Amaia with her son against her ribs. Show the children within the third canoe, exhausted and alert to a change behind them.	Cloth movement and breath over the water. Do not reveal the baby’s small stone.
22-32 s	On the bank, a soldier raises the pole-mounted brass bell and rings it lightly. Amaia reacts through her jaw.	One controlled bell strike with a felt low resonance; avoid a loud horror sting.
32-42 s	The three children turn toward the bell together. Blue leaves their arms toward the bank. Cut to the clerk recording without looking up.	Water continues. Bell decay and pen movement. No villain speech.
42-54 s	The seven-year-old girl addresses the water. Dairon turns the bow into the roots. The hull scrapes; a paddle snaps.	“There’s a way under the roots.” Wood strains and breaks.
54-65 s	The canoes emerge through the channel. The nine-year-old boy keeps his head tilted toward the distant bell.	“They know where we were. They don’t know where we are.”
65-79 s	Beheto presses both palms into the drum. Show the vibration through hull and water; the current begins carrying them faster than their strokes.	Drum resonance travels downward. No giant wave, portal or explosive power effect.
79-90 s	Against Amaia, her son speaks. She moves with the turn. Cut back to the clerk finishing his line and closing the ledger.	“It’s turning with us.” / “Turn with it.” Finish on the book closing; proposed cut to the Bronx at 3:07.

Continuity: the three “lit” children and Amaia’s son are not interchangeable. Preserve the separate canoes and wrapped stone. Avoid a full inventory close-up of the baby’s hands. The larger explanation belongs to the later river return.

CHECKPOINT 01 / REVIEW GATE

Your choices before production

Source wording needs your decision

The supplied PDF opens: “Amaia had fourteen when they put the canoes in. By the third night she had eleven.” Your earlier approved revision begins: “There had been fourteen of them when they entered the river.” It develops the losses through remembered physical actions. That revision is not in this attachment. The proposed film sequence uses shared on-screen events and adds no opening narration, so it does not silently choose one prose version over the other.

Visual direction to preserve

Your established polished, full-color Cemí direction: expressive hand-drawn-derived faces, clean comic/anime linework, minimal sketch residue, dark navy and steel shadows, charcoal, amber highlights where the lighting supports them, and restrained cel shading. Keep character designs distinct. No decorative quotes, unexplained lettering or graffiti. The tutorial’s 1990s treatment is a reference workflow, not an approved replacement for your style.

The next concrete deliverable

After your review of this opening: one reference board for Amaia and her son, then a separate check of canoe layout, Beheto, Yara’s wrapped stone, the bell and the ledger. Retrieve and inspect existing approved art before making matching assets. Any costume, face or setting detail absent from the manuscript must be presented as a design proposal.

Then: one approved first frame, followed by one 5-8 second animation test. Start with a simple canoe movement and Amaia’s physical reaction. Inspect character stability, hand anatomy, paddle/water contact and actual movement before attempting the multi-character channel turn.

How the stops will work

Checkpoint	What you inspect before the next step
1. This packet	Story fidelity, opening sequence, source wording.
2. Reference art	Faces, clothing, props, palette, canoe positions.
3. Storyboard + voice samples	Framing, timing, exact dialogue, performance.
4. One motion test	Real action, stable designs, physical coherence.
5. Complete first scene	Edited motion, consistent sound and color.
6. Each subsequent sequence	New script choices and additions, then its production results.

PAUSED FOR YOUR REVIEW. Approving this packet would approve development of the opening only. It would not approve automatic generation of the full movie.